

TOURNAMENT PREPARATION GUIDE

FM ARLAN CABE

24th ASEAN+ Age-Group Chess Championships 2026

Standard S50 & W50 Open and Women

9 ROUNDS

Swiss system

90 + 30

Standard time control

8-14 AUG

Our Tampines Hub

PURPOSE

Fast, color-specific decisions when a Swiss pairing is posted: one opening plan, one position type to seek, one danger to avoid.

Prepared 1 August 2026 from the supplied opponent PGNs, Arlan's local game file, the tournament starting list, and a limited Stockfish check of critical positions at depth 12.

PRIVATE COACHING MATERIAL

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Tournament schedule and key facts

EVENT FACTS

24th ASEAN+ Age-Group Chess Championships 2026, Standard S50 & W50 Open and Women. Nine-round Swiss, 90 minutes plus 30 seconds per move, Our Tampines Hub, Singapore. Manila and Singapore are both UTC+8.

HOW TO READ THE GAME DATA

Recent means standard games dated 2022-2026. Career means all standard games in the supplied file. Percentages are scores from the named opponent's point of view. Asterisked chart samples have fewer than 12 recent games.

Standard schedule

Round	Date	Start	Preparation note
R1	Sat 8 Aug	15:30	Full morning; stop opening work by lunch
R2	Sun 9 Aug	09:00	Night-before card only
R3	Mon 10 Aug	09:00	First double-round day
R4	Mon 10 Aug	15:30	Recovery beats new opening study
R5	Tue 11 Aug	09:00	Second double-round day
R6	Tue 11 Aug	15:30	Use the backup line if pairing is late
-	Wed 12 Aug	Free day	Review only patterns that appeared
R7	Thu 13 Aug	09:00	Third double-round day
R8	Thu 13 Aug	15:30	Energy and clock discipline
R9	Fri 14 Aug	09:00	Simple, familiar opening only

Double-round rule

- For afternoon rounds, review only the assigned opponent card, the first 8-10 moves, and one practice position.
- No new branch after the morning game. If the opponent surprises, use the tournament-wide backup structure.
- Eat, walk, reset, then spend no more than 35 minutes on chess before the afternoon round.

90+30 time checkpoints

Checkpoint	Minimum time left	Decision rule
After move 10	75 min	Opening recall ends; calculate independently
After move 20	55 min	Name the worst piece and the opponent's break
After move 30	35 min	Keep a 3-minute reserve for every difficult calculation
After move 40	20 min	Use increment; do not blitz a technical ending

Schedule source: event invitation schedule summarized by Chessqueen; tournament format and starting list cross-checked on Chess-Results. Links are listed in Sources and method.

Arlan's tournament-wide plan

MAIN STRATEGIC FACT

In the local recent classical sample Arlan scores 77.8% with White but 34.6% with Black. The preparation should protect the Black games and use White to create the winning chances.

Sample	Games	W-D-L	Score
All recent classical	22	9-5-8	52.3%
White	9	6-2-1	77.8%
Black	13	3-3-7	34.6%
Games reaching move 41	10	6-1-3 65.0%	Use as strength

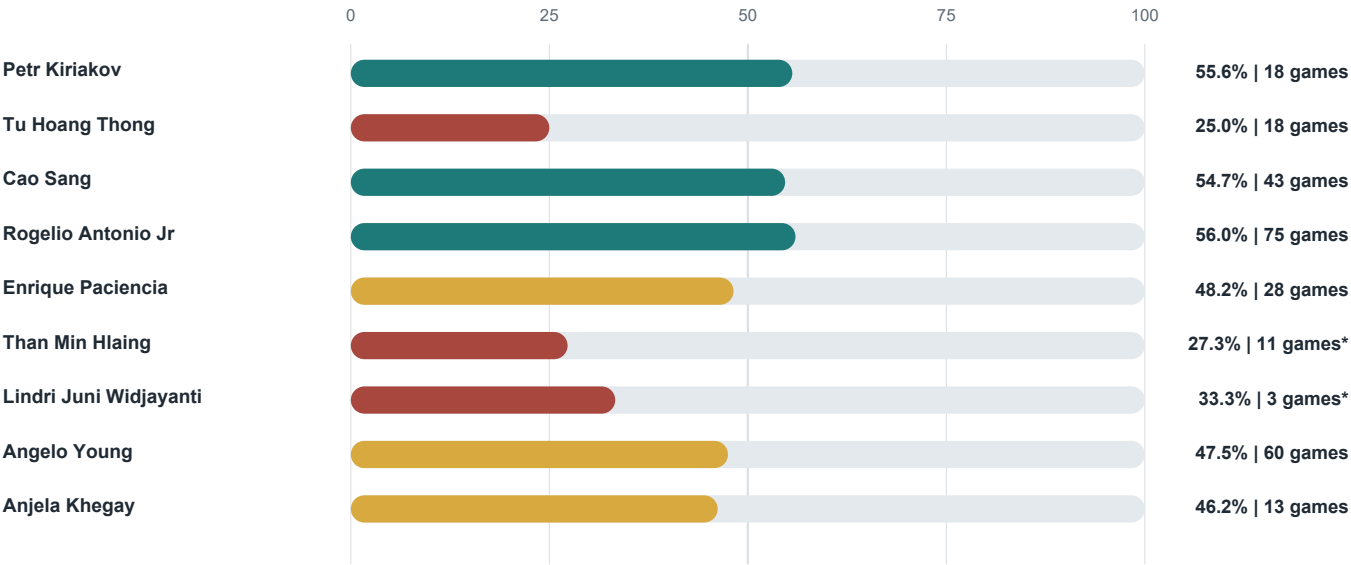
Opening choices to keep

- White: 1.e4 is the default. Keep one answer ready for Sicilian, Caro-Kann, French, 1...e5 and Modern/Pirc.
- Black versus 1.e4: the rehearsed Sicilian/Najdorf is the primary prepared choice. Use a solid backup only when the opponent's anti-Sicilian is a known comfort line.
- Black versus 1.d4, 1.Nf3 or 1.c4: one ...d5 family only - Slav or QGD by move order. Do not improvise a King's Indian or Benoni mid-event.
- Endgames: Arlan's recent long-game result is a relative strength. Keep rooks active and preserve clock for move 35 onward.

What not to memorize

- Do not memorize all of an opponent's opening choices. Learn the first decision point and the intended pawn structure.
- Do not turn a small database score into a claim of weakness. Samples below eight games only suggest possible directions.
- Do not abandon a familiar opening because one opponent card contains a different opening line.

Recent classical form in the supplied files



Score is from the opponent's point of view. The chart measures only the supplied recent classical sample; it is not a rating forecast. An asterisk marks fewer than 12 games.

HOW TO READ THE CHART

Tu and Than have weak recent files, but that does not justify risky play. Antonio, Cao and Kiriakov have enough current or consistent opening evidence to justify detailed work. Widjayanti's recent sample is too small for a confident form claim.

Opponent preparation priorities

A+ means prepare first; A means complete a full card; B means keep the card ready but spend less opening-study time. Priority combines rating proximity, pairing likelihood, how recent the games are, and clarity of the target.

Rank	Seed / opponent	Recent classical	Arlan White	Arlan Black
A+	4 GM Rogelio Antonio Jr (2333)	75 games 25-34-16 56.0%	Caro Exchange 4.Bd3	Moscow with ...Bd7
A+	6 IM Enrique Paciencia (2259)	28 games 11-5-12 48.2%	Ruy Exchange	...c6 and ...d5
A	2 GM Tu Hoang Thong (2346)	18 games 3-3-12 25.0%	1.e4, simple branches	Najdorf vs 2.d3/b3
A	3 GM Cao Sang (2344)	43 games 13-21-9 54.7%	Advance French	Najdorf + Moscow
A	7 Than Min Hlaing (2140)	11 games 2-2-7 27.3%	Open Sicilian	Immediate ...d5
A	9 IM Angelo Young (2119)	60 games 21-15-24 47.5%	1.e4, hit Sicilian	Slav/QGD vs d4
A	10 WIM Anjela Kheday (2012)	13 games 5-2-6 46.2%	Be3 vs Modern	Quiet Slav
B	1 GM Petr Kiriakov (2459)	18 games 5-10-3 55.6%	Tarrasch French	QGD, no Nimzo
B	8 WIM Lindri Juni Widjayanti (2127)	3 games 1-0-2 33.3%	Flexible 1.e4	Mainline Najdorf

Tournament-wide backup choices

Color / opponent first move	Backup structure	First objective
Arlan White	1.e4	Reach a known pawn structure by move 6
Arlan Black vs 1.e4	Sicilian / Najdorf	Complete development before a pawn race
Arlan Black vs 1.d4	QGD or Slav	Contest e4 and prepare ...c5
Arlan Black vs 1.Nf3/c4	...d5 or ...c6 then ...d5	Prevent long Catalan/English pressure

WHEN PAIRINGS ARE POSTED

1) confirm color and opponent identity; 2) read the bottom line; 3) replay the prepared line once without notes; 4) solve the two practice positions; 5) write one sentence: pawn structure, opponent break, worst piece; 6) stop.

GM Petr Kiriakov - color plan

SEED 1 FID FIDE 4119231	GM Petr Kiriakov Rating 2459	MEDIUM EVIDENCE Recent games: 18
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PRIORITY B - BOTTOM LINE

No cheap target. Keep the opening familiar, make him solve a full game, and avoid a long Nimzo-Indian memory test when Arlan has Black.

ARLAN HAS WHITE

Prepared line: 1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nd2

Plan: Use a Tarrasch French setup with Ngf3, Bd3, O-O and a timed e5 or exd5 decision. Be ready for an early ...h6 without reacting emotionally.

Avoid: Do not switch to a Catalan only because the database score looks tempting unless that structure is already rehearsed.

ARLAN HAS BLACK

Prepared line: 1.d4 d5 2.c4 e6

Plan: Choose a QGD setup: Nf6, Be7, O-O, Nbd7 and ...c5. Meet 3.Nf3 with the same structure so the move order stays stable.

Avoid: Avoid 1...Nf6 2.c4 e6 3.Nc3 Bb4. His recent and career Nimzo results are strong.

Games and results

Game sample	Games	W-D-L	Score
Career classical (2008-2026)	85	32-37-16	59.4%
Recent classical (2022+)	18	5-10-3	55.6%
Recent as White	9	2-6-1	55.6%
Recent as Black	9	3-4-2	55.6%
Recent games 41+ moves	6	2-2-2	50.0%

Opening tendencies

Question	Recent 2022+ (18 games)	Career reference
Opponent has White: first move	d4 9 (100%)	d4 43 (100%)
Opponent has Black vs 1.e4	e6 5 / 60.0%	e6 20 / 62.5%

Recorded opening sequences

Opponent has	Recorded opening sequence	Games / score
White	1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 e6 3.Nc3 Bb4	3 / 66.7%
White	1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nc3 d5	2 / 50.0%
Black vs 1.e4	1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nc3 Nf6 4.e5 Nfd7	2 / 25.0%
Black vs 1.e4	1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nd2 h6 4.Ngf3 Nf6	1 / 100.0%

Practical notes

- Aim: Resistance and decision quality after move 30. Four of his 18 recent classical games were short draws, but that is a tendency, not an invitation to force matters.
- Watch for: He played 1.d4 in every recent White game and has broad experience against every major Indian defense.

Percentages above are opponent scores, not Arlan scores. Small line samples are preparation prompts, not predictions.

GM Petr Kiriakov - practice positions

Use these games to train decisions, not to memorize the opponent's mistakes. Recreate each critical position, set five minutes, and write three possible moves before checking the engine line. Positive engine values favor the opponent; negative values favor Arlan.

2026.02.13 | White vs Ansat,Aldiyar | Loss

Opening: Queen's Gambit Declined: Exchange Variation, Positional Variation (D35)

Recorded line: 1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 e6 3.Nc3 d5 4.cxd5 exd5 5.Bg5 c6

Critical moment: 50.Be2 - played Be2; Stockfish preferred Kh2

Engine check: serious error, 1.52 pawns; evaluation for the opponent -2.04 to -3.56

Best line: 1.Kh2 Rh3+ 2.Kg1 Re4 3.Qd6

Study theme: The decisive errors arrived only in an already difficult rook position. Study resistance: active rook first, material second.

Selected-game engine check: average estimated loss 0.19 pawns over 49 moves. This is not a career accuracy measure.

2026.02.14 | Black vs Davtyan,Artur | Loss

Opening: French Defense: Steinitz Variation, Boleslavsky Variation (C11)

Recorded line: 1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nc3 Nf6 4.e5 Nfd7 5.f4 c5

Critical moment: 12...a5 - played a5; Stockfish preferred Bxc5

Engine check: inaccuracy, 0.99 pawns; evaluation for the opponent -1.20 to -2.19

Best line: 1.Bxc5 Bxc5 2.Nxc5 Rc1 3.Qa5+

Study theme: In the French loss, ...a5 missed a forcing capture. Train the forcing-move scan before a slow pawn move.

Selected-game engine check: average estimated loss 0.16 pawns over 26 moves. This is not a career accuracy measure.

Three drills before the event

- QGD move-order recall through move 12.
- French Tarrasch: one line versus ...Nf6 and one versus an early ...h6.
- Defensive rook positions: identify the most active rook square before taking material.

Pairing-day final check

Check	Write one answer
Expected pawn structure	_____
Opponent's main break	_____
My worst piece after development	_____
Clock floor at move 20	55 minutes

GM Tu Hoang Thong - color plan

SEED 2 VIE FIDE 12400076	GM Tu Hoang Thong Rating 2346	MEDIUM EVIDENCE Recent games: 18
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PRIORITY A - BOTTOM LINE

The recent file is poor, especially in long games, but the opponent is still a GM with many opening choices over his career. Press patiently; do not play as if the point is owed.

ARLAN HAS WHITE

Prepared line: 1.e4

Plan: Against 1...e5 use a quiet Italian; against 1...e6 use the Tarrasch French; against 1...c5 play a normal Open Sicilian. Keep one branch per reply.

Avoid: Do not burn time trying to guess his first move response. His recent Black opening choices changed from game to game.

ARLAN HAS BLACK

Prepared line: 1.e4 c5 2.Nf3 d6

Plan: Expect 2.d3, 2.b3 or a Closed Sicilian. Develop with ...Nc6, ...g6, ...Bg7 and ...e6 or ...Nge7 before choosing a pawn break.

Avoid: Do not treat a quiet anti-Sicilian as harmless and launch ...f5 or ...d5 before the king is safe.

Games and results

Game sample	Games	W-D-L	Score
Career classical (2015-2026)	100	35-36-29	53.0%
Recent classical (2022+)	18	3-3-12	25.0%
Recent as White	9	2-1-6	27.8%
Recent as Black	9	1-2-6	22.2%
Recent games 41+ moves	9	1-1-7	16.7%

Opening tendencies

Question	Recent 2022+ (18 games)	Career reference
Opponent has White: first move	e4 8 (89%), d4 1 (11%)	e4 20 (40%), d4 11 (22%), Nf3 8 (16%), b3 7 (14%)
Opponent has Black vs 1.e4	e5 2 / 0.0%, e6 1 / 100.0%, c5 1 / 0.0%	c5 7 / 57.1%, e5 5 / 20.0%, e6 4 / 75.0%, Nc6 1 / 50.0%

Recorded opening sequences

Opponent has	Recorded opening sequence	Games / score
White	1.e4 c5 2.d3 Nc6 3.g3 g6	2 / 25.0%
White	1.e4 c5 2.Nc3 Nc6 3.Bb5 Nd4	1 / 100.0%
Black vs 1.e4	1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nc3 Bb4 4.exd5 exd5	1 / 100.0%
Black vs 1.e4	1.e4 e5 2.Nc3 Nf6 3.d4 exd4 4.Qxd4 Nc6	1 / 0.0%

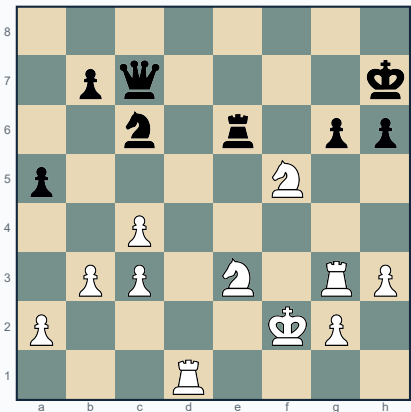
Practical notes

- Aim: A long game. The recent classical score is lowest in 41-plus-move games, and the selected loss contains two costly knight decisions.
- Watch for: Career evidence includes the Dutch, Sicilian, French, Slav and irregular first moves. Recent evidence should outweigh old frequency, but surprise value remains.

Percentages above are opponent scores, not Arlan scores. Small line samples are preparation prompts, not predictions.

GM Tu Hoang Thong - practice positions

Use these games to train decisions, not to memorize the opponent's mistakes. Recreate each critical position, set five minutes, and write three possible moves before checking the engine line. Positive engine values favor the opponent; negative values favor Arlan.



2026.01.02 | White vs Quizon, Daniel | Loss

Opening: Sicilian Defense: Czerniak Attack (B20)

Recorded line: 1.e4 c5 2.b3 d6 3.Bb2 e5 4.Bc4 Nf6 5.Nc3 Be7

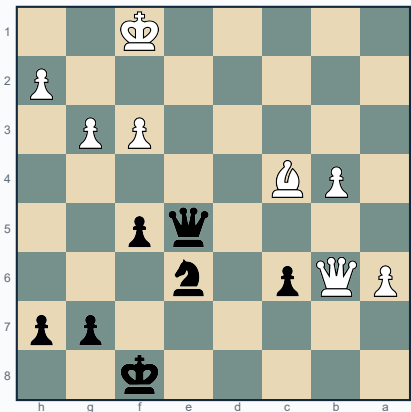
Critical moment: 47.Nd5 - played Nd5; Stockfish preferred Nd4

Engine check: blunder, 3.25 pawns; evaluation for the opponent +0.20 to -3.05

Best line: 1.Nd4 Rf6+ 2.Rf3 Qe7 3.Ke2

Study theme: The game turned on knight placement: Ndf4 and later Nd5 allowed tactical swings. Compare every knight jump with the retreat square.

Selected-game engine check: average estimated loss 0.29 pawns over 48 moves. This is not a career accuracy measure.



2026.01.04 | Black vs Chernyavsky, Alexander | Loss

Opening: Dutch Defense: Classical Variation (A90)

Recorded line: 1.d4 f5 2.g3 Nf6 3.Bg2 e6 4.c4 c6 5.Nc3 d5

Critical moment: 36...Qa1+ - played Qa1+; Stockfish preferred Qc3

Engine check: serious error, 1.55 pawns; evaluation for the opponent -2.88 to -4.43

Best line: 1.Qc3 Be2 2.Qc1+ Kf2 3.Qh1

Study theme: The Dutch loss did not contain a single large blunder in the scan; the position worsened through small weaknesses in the pawn structure.

Selected-game engine check: average estimated loss 0.22 pawns over 32 moves. This is not a career accuracy measure.

Three drills before the event

- Defend 2.d3 and 2.b3 Sicilians without an early pawn lunge.
- Knight retreat exercise: list every safe retreat before occupying d5 or f4.
- One 45-minute technical ending from an equal position.

Pairing-day final check

Check	Write one answer
Expected pawn structure	_____
Opponent's main break	_____
My worst piece after development	_____
Clock floor at move 20	55 minutes

GM Cao Sang - color plan

SEED 3 VIE FIDE 725056	GM Cao Sang Rating 2344	HIGH EVIDENCE Recent games: 43
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PRIORITY A - BOTTOM LINE

His recent color split is sharp: strong as White, much softer as Black. With White, Arlan should make the French Advance the main target; with Black, prepare for 1.e4 only.

ARLAN HAS WHITE Prepared line: 1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.e5 c5 4.c3 Plan: Develop with Nf3, Be2 or Bd3, O-O and Na3-c2 when needed. Keep the center intact until development is complete. Avoid: Do not rush f4-f5 or grab on c5 while the queenside pieces are undeveloped.	ARLAN HAS BLACK Prepared line: 1.e4 c5 2.Nf3 d6 Plan: Use Arlan's Najdorf after 3.d4. Also rehearse one answer to 3.Bb5+; 3...Bd7 is the low-memory option. Avoid: Avoid choosing the French as a surprise. Cao's recent White score against the French is one of his strongest families.
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Games and results

Game sample	Games	W-D-L	Score
Career classical (2018-2023)	100	40-42-18	61.0%
Recent classical (2022+)	43	13-21-9	54.7%
Recent as White	20	10-8-2	70.0%
Recent as Black	23	3-13-7	41.3%
Recent games 41+ moves	19	7-6-6	52.6%

Opening tendencies

Question	Recent 2022+ (43 games)	Career reference
Opponent has White: first move	e4 20 (100%)	e4 45 (94%), Nf3 2 (4%), d4 1 (2%)
Opponent has Black vs 1.e4	e6 4 / 25.0%, c5 2 / 75.0%	e6 7 / 35.7%, c5 6 / 83.3%

Recorded opening sequences

Opponent has	Recorded opening sequence	Games / score
White	1.e4 c5 2.Nf3 d6 3.d4 cxd4	3 / 33.3%
White	1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nc3 Nf6	2 / 100.0%
Black vs 1.e4	1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.e5 c5 4.c3 Nc6	2 / 25.0%
Black vs 1.e4	1.e4 c5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 g6 4.d4 cxd4	1 / 100.0%

Practical notes

- Aim: His Black French sample and the choice between piece and pawn recaptures. Make him commit to a structure before opening the position.
- Watch for: He played 1.e4 in all 20 recent White games and scored well. Ten recent games involved queenside castling, so opposite-wing attacks are a real possibility.

Percentages above are opponent scores, not Arlan scores. Small line samples are preparation prompts, not predictions.

GM Cao Sang - practice positions

Use these games to train decisions, not to memorize the opponent's mistakes. Recreate each critical position, set five minutes, and write three possible moves before checking the engine line. Positive engine values favor the opponent; negative values favor Arlan.

2023.04.21 | White vs Ngo,Thanh Tung | Loss

Opening: Sicilian Defense: Closed (B23)

Recorded line: 1.e4 c5 2.Nc3 a6 3.g3 Nc6 4.Bg2 g6 5.Nf3 Bg7

Critical moment: 32.Rc2 - played Rc2; Stockfish preferred f4

Engine check: serious error, 1.94 pawns; evaluation for the opponent -1.16 to -3.10

Best line: 1.f4 Bh5 2.c5 Be2 3.cxd6

Study theme: Bxd7 and Rc2 were passive exchange/rook choices. The training theme is preserving active pieces rather than simplifying automatically.

Selected-game engine check: average estimated loss 0.25 pawns over 34 moves. This is not a career accuracy measure.

2023.12.10 | Black vs Ilamparthi,AR. | Loss

Opening: French Defense: Advance Variation, Main Line (C02)

Recorded line: 1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.e5 c5 4.c3 Nc6 5.Nf3 Qb6

Critical moment: 28...Qxf6 - played Qxf6; Stockfish preferred gxf6

Engine check: serious error, 2.08 pawns; evaluation for the opponent -0.59 to -2.67

Best line: 1.gxf6 Ne3 2.Qh7 f4 3.Rdg8

Study theme: In the French example, ...Qxf6 was inferior to ...gxf6. Do not assume the cleaner-looking recapture is best.

Selected-game engine check: average estimated loss 0.14 pawns over 38 moves. This is not a career accuracy measure.

Three drills before the event

- Advance French: 10 minutes of c5/d4 pressure patterns.
- Moscow variation: choose and memorize one reply to Bb5+.
- Recapture-choice positions: compare queen, g-pawn and piece recaptures.

Pairing-day final check

Check	Write one answer
Expected pawn structure	_____
Opponent's main break	_____
My worst piece after development	_____
Clock floor at move 20	55 minutes

GM Rogelio Antonio Jr - color plan

SEED 4 PHI FIDE 5200032	GM Rogelio Antonio Jr Rating 2333	HIGH EVIDENCE Recent games: 75
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PRIORITY A+ - BOTTOM LINE
Highest preparation priority: a direct standings rival with a very current 75-game classical file. Attack his Caro-Kann with the Exchange setup; expect Bb5+ against Arlan's Sicilian.

ARLAN HAS WHITE Prepared line: 1.e4 c6 2.d4 d5 3.exd5 cxd5 4.Bd3 Plan: Continue Nf3, c3, O-O, Re1 and Bf4 or Nd2. Keep queens on long enough to ask practical questions. Avoid: Do not drift into a random Advance Caro-Kann; his current file shows several successful setups there.	ARLAN HAS BLACK Prepared line: 1.e4 c5 2.Nf3 d6 3.Bb5+ Bd7 Plan: After Bxd7+ Qxd7, use ...Nf6, ...g6, ...Bg7 and ...O-O. Accept a slightly quiet position and compete on the c-file and dark squares. Avoid: Do not improvise after 3.Bb5+. It is a repeated current choice for him against both ...Nc6 and ...d6.
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Games and results

Game sample	Games	W-D-L	Score
Career classical (2025-2026)	75	25-34-16	56.0%
Recent classical (2022+)	75	25-34-16	56.0%
Recent as White	40	17-17-6	63.8%
Recent as Black	35	8-17-10	47.1%
Recent games 41+ moves	29	12-9-8	56.9%

Opening tendencies

Question	Recent 2022+ (75 games)	Career reference
Opponent has White: first move	e4 40 (100%)	e4 40 (100%)
Opponent has Black vs 1.e4	c6 9 / 44.4%, c5 2 / 50.0%, g6 1 / 100.0%	c6 9 / 44.4%, c5 2 / 50.0%, g6 1 / 100.0%

Recorded opening sequences

Opponent has	Recorded opening sequence	Games / score
White	1.e4 c5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 g6	4 / 75.0%
White	1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nf6 3.Nxe5 d6	3 / 83.3%
Black vs 1.e4	1.e4 c6 2.d4 d5 3.exd5 cxd5 4.Bd3 Nc6	2 / 0.0%
Black vs 1.e4	1.e4 g6 2.h4 h6 3.Nc3 Bg7 4.d4 d6	1 / 100.0%

Practical notes

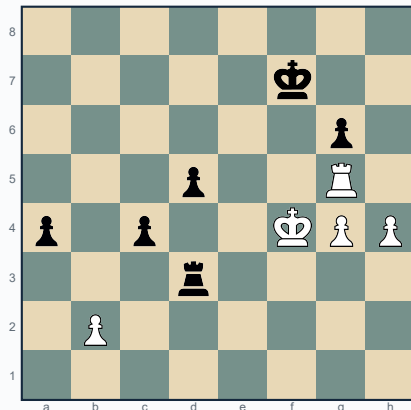
- Aim: Caro-Kann Exchange structures and pawn-race calculation. His recent Black Caro sample scores below 50 percent and contains four losses.
- Watch for: He played 1.e4 in every recent White game in the current file, with strong Rossolimo/Moscow and Petroff results.

Percentages above are opponent scores, not Arlan scores. Small line samples are preparation prompts, not predictions.

GM Rogelio Antonio Jr - practice positions

Use these games to train decisions, not to memorize the opponent's mistakes. Recreate each critical position, set five minutes, and write three possible moves before checking the engine line. Positive engine values favor the opponent; negative values favor Arlan.

2026.06.27 | White vs Garcia,Jan Emmanuel | Loss



Opening: Scotch Game: Classical Variation (C45)

Recorded line: 1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.d4 exd4 4.Nxd4 Bc5 5.Be3 Qf6

Critical moment: 41.Re5 - played Re5; Stockfish preferred h5

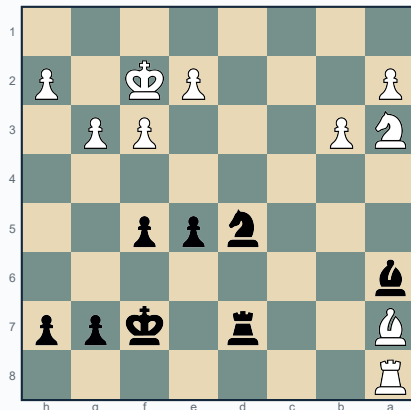
Engine check: serious error, 1.78 pawns; evaluation for the opponent -1.04 to -2.82

Best line: 1.h5 a3 2.bxa3 c3 3.Rxg6

Study theme: In the rook ending, Re5 missed the urgent h-pawn push. Advancing the passed pawn came before rook activity.

Selected-game engine check: average estimated loss 0.15 pawns over 42 moves. This is not a career accuracy measure.

2026.07.01 | Black vs Laylo,Darwin | Loss



Opening: Catalan Opening: Open Defense, Classical Line (E05)

Recorded line: 1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 e6 3.Nf3 d5 4.g3 Be7 5.Bg2 O-O

Critical moment: 34...Bxe2 - played Bxe2; Stockfish preferred Nc7

Engine check: serious error, 2.22 pawns; evaluation for the opponent -1.27 to -3.49

Best line: 1.Nc7 Rh8 2.Rd2 Nc4 3.Bxc4

Study theme: As Black in the Catalan, Bxe2 grabbed material while ...Nc7 was the defensive priority. Decline material when a piece must regroup.

Selected-game engine check: average estimated loss 0.20 pawns over 44 moves. This is not a career accuracy measure.

Three drills before the event

- Caro-Kann Exchange key opening position through move 10, from both sides.
- Moscow defense: one complete practice game with ...Bd7.
- King-and-pawn races: count the moves to promotion before moving the rook.

Pairing-day final check

Check	Write one answer
Expected pawn structure	_____
Opponent's main break	_____
My worst piece after development	_____
Clock floor at move 20	55 minutes

IM Enrique Paciencia - color plan

SEED 6 SGP FIDE 5201322	IM Enrique Paciencia Rating 2259	HIGH EVIDENCE Recent games: 28
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PRIORITY A+ - BOTTOM LINE
Direct rating rival. Steer his White games into a Slav rather than his comfortable English; with White, use the Ruy Exchange to build a long technical game.

ARLAN HAS WHITE Prepared line: 1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 4.Bxc6 Plan: Use d3, O-O, Re1, Nbd2-f1-g3 and a kingside majority. The goal is a stable structure and repeated small decisions. Avoid: Do not choose the Scotch only because it is forcing; it is one of his most repeated current Black lines.	ARLAN HAS BLACK Prepared line: 1.c4 c6 and 1.d4 d5 2.c4 c6 Plan: Force a Slav/Quiet Slav structure with ...Nf6, ...Bf5 or ...e6, ...Nbd7 and a prepared ...e5 or ...c5 break. Avoid: Avoid 1.c4 e5 unless it is deeply rehearsed. His recent English/Reti results are strong.
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Games and results

Game sample	Games	W-D-L	Score
Career classical (2009-2026)	100	37-25-38	49.5%
Recent classical (2022+)	28	11-5-12	48.2%
Recent as White	15	6-2-7	46.7%
Recent as Black	13	5-3-5	50.0%
Recent games 41+ moves	13	4-2-7	38.5%

Opening tendencies

Question	Recent 2022+ (28 games)	Career reference
Opponent has White: first move	c4 8 (53%), d4 7 (47%)	d4 33 (65%), c4 12 (24%), Nf3 5 (10%), g3 1 (2%)
Opponent has Black vs 1.e4	e5 5 / 60.0%, c5 1 / 50.0%, d6 1 / 0.0%	e5 24 / 45.8%, d6 3 / 33.3%, c5 3 / 16.7%, c6 1 / 50.0%

Recorded opening sequences

Opponent has	Recorded opening sequence	Games / score
White	1.c4 e5 2.Nc3 Nf6 3.Nf3 Nc6	2 / 50.0%
White	1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 e6 3.Nf3 d5	2 / 50.0%
Black vs 1.e4	1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.d4 exd4 4.Nxd4 Bc5	4 / 50.0%
Black vs 1.e4	1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 4.Ba4 Nf6	1 / 100.0%

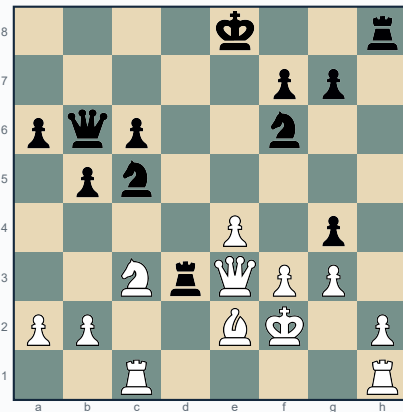
Practical notes

- Aim: Late decision-making. Seven of his 12 recent classical losses occurred after move 40, and the late-game score is below his overall recent score.
- Watch for: He alternates 1.c4 and 1.d4 and can reach the same positions through different move orders. Identify the pawn structure, not the first-move label.

Percentages above are opponent scores, not Arlan scores. Small line samples are preparation prompts, not predictions.

IM Enrique Paciencia - practice positions

Use these games to train decisions, not to memorize the opponent's mistakes. Recreate each critical position, set five minutes, and write three possible moves before checking the engine line. Positive engine values favor the opponent; negative values favor Arlan.



2026.02.07 | White vs Tin,Jingyao | Loss

Opening: Slav Defense: Quiet Variation, Schallop Defense (D12)

Recorded line: 1.c4 c6 2.d4 d5 3.Nf3 Nf6 4.e3 Bf5 5.Nc3 e6

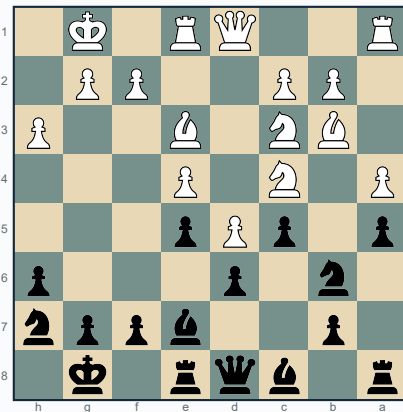
Critical moment: 24.Nd5 - played Nd5; Stockfish preferred Bxd3

Engine check: serious error, 1.46 pawns; evaluation for the opponent -1.74 to -3.20

Best line: 1.Bxd3 Nxd3+ 2.Ke2 Nxc1+ 3.Qxc1

Study theme: In the Slav loss, Nd5 and an exposed king magnified the pressure. Exchange the dangerous attacker before placing a piece on a fixed central square.

Selected-game engine check: average estimated loss 0.24 pawns over 26 moves. This is not a career accuracy measure.



2026.02.08 | Black vs Susilodinata,Andreas | Loss

Opening: Philidor Defense: Lion Variation (C41)

Recorded line: 1.e4 d6 2.d4 Nf6 3.Nc3 e5 4.Nf3 Nbd7 5.Bc4 Be7

Critical moment: 14...Nd7 - played Nd7; Stockfish preferred Nxc4

Engine check: serious error, 1.21 pawns; evaluation for the opponent -0.55 to -1.76

Best line: 1.Nxc4 Bxc4 2.Bg5 Ra3 3.Rf8

Study theme: In the Philidor loss, quiet piece retreats repeatedly lost ground. Look for active captures and pawn breaks before accepting passivity.

Selected-game engine check: average estimated loss 0.18 pawns over 45 moves. This is not a career accuracy measure.

Three drills before the event

- Ruy Exchange structure: kingside majority and good/bad bishop plan.
- Slav Quiet: one route to ...e5 and one route to ...c5.
- Convert a slightly better rook ending without rushing pawn captures.

Pairing-day final check

Check	Write one answer
Expected pawn structure	_____
Opponent's main break	_____
My worst piece after development	_____
Clock floor at move 20	55 minutes

Than Min Hlaing - color plan

SEED 7 MYA FIDE 13001353	Than Min Hlaing Rating 2140	LOW EVIDENCE Recent games: 11
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PRIORITY A - BOTTOM LINE

A clear scoring opportunity, but the file has only 26 games. Use the clear pattern - Open Sicilian with White, immediate ...d5 against 1.Nf3 - without drawing detailed conclusions from too few games.

ARLAN HAS WHITE

Prepared line: 1.e4 c5 2.Nf3 d6 3.d4 cxd4 4.Nxd4

Plan: Choose a classical Be2/O-O setup and improve every piece before a kingside pawn push. Keep the center fluid.

Avoid: Do not turn the game into a risky attack just because the rating is lower.

ARLAN HAS BLACK

Prepared line: 1.Nf3 d5 2.d4 Nf6 3.c4 e6

Plan: Use QGD development and contest e4. If he starts 1.c4, answer 1...e6 or 1...c6 with ...d5 next.

Avoid: Do not allow a free King's Indian setup; that is the most repeated White family in the small file.

Games and results

Game sample	Games	W-D-L	Score
Career classical (2016-2024)	26	10-4-12	46.2%
Recent classical (2022+)	11	2-2-7	27.3%
Recent as White	5	1-2-2	40.0%
Recent as Black	6	1-0-5	16.7%
Recent games 41+ moves	6	1-2-3	33.3%

Opening tendencies

Question	Recent 2022+ (11 games)	Career reference
Opponent has White: first move	Nf3 4 (80%), c4 1 (20%)	Nf3 9 (69%), c4 1 (8%), g3 1 (8%), e4 1 (8%)
Opponent has Black vs 1.e4	c5 4 / 25.0%	c5 8 / 37.5%, d6 1 / 100.0%

Recorded opening sequences

Opponent has	Recorded opening sequence	Games / score
White	1.Nf3 d5 2.d4 Bf5 3.c4 e6	1 / 100.0%
White	1.c4 Nf6 2.Nc3 g6 3.e4 d6	1 / 50.0%
Black vs 1.e4	1.e4 c5 2.Nf3 d6 3.d4 cxd4 4.Nxd4 Nf6	3 / 33.3%
Black vs 1.e4	1.e4 c5 2.Nc3 Nc6 3.Nge2 e5 4.Ng3 g6	1 / 0.0%

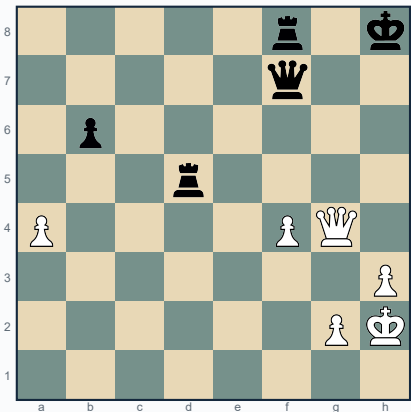
Practical notes

- Aim: The 20-30 move transition and Black-side Sicilians. The recent Black score is especially low, but the sample is small.
- Watch for: No recent short draws: expect resistance. The file is limited enough that a first-move surprise is plausible.

Percentages above are opponent scores, not Arlan scores. Small line samples are preparation prompts, not predictions.

Than Min Hlaing - practice positions

Use these games to train decisions, not to memorize the opponent's mistakes. Recreate each critical position, set five minutes, and write three possible moves before checking the engine line. Positive engine values favor the opponent; negative values favor Arlan.



2024.09.19 | White vs Blackman,Justin | Loss

Opening: Zukertort Opening: Black Mustang Defense (A04)

Recorded line: 1.Nf3 Nc6 2.d4 e6 3.c4 Nf6 4.Bg5 h6 5.Bxf6 Qxf6

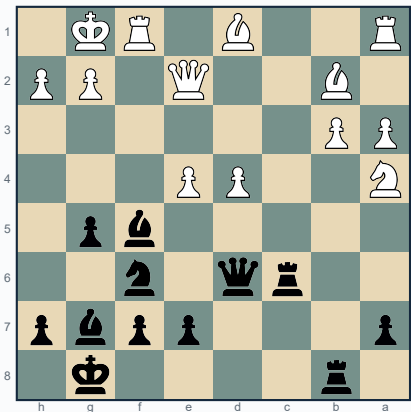
Critical moment: 39.g3 - played g3; Stockfish preferred h4

Engine check: blunder, 10.00 pawns; evaluation for the opponent -6.50 to forced mate for Arlan

Best line: 1.h4 Qxf4+ 2.Qxf4 Rxf4 3.Kg3

Study theme: Be4 overlooked a better retreat square. Do not place a piece in the center when it becomes a tactical target.

Selected-game engine check: average estimated loss 0.45 pawns over 35 moves. This is not a career accuracy measure.



2024.09.20 | Black vs Tan,Jun Ying | Loss

Opening: Slav Defense: Quiet Variation (D11)

Recorded line: 1.d4 d5 2.c4 c6 3.Nf3 Nf6 4.e3 g6 5.Nc3 Bg7

Critical moment: 22...Bg4 - played Bg4; Stockfish preferred Nxe4

Engine check: serious error, 2.49 pawns; evaluation for the opponent +0.68 to -1.81

Best line: 1.Nxe4 Rxf5 2.Bxd4+ Kh1 3.Ng3+

Study theme: As Black in the Slav, Bg4 missed Nxe4. Scan central captures before developing while attacking another piece.

Selected-game engine check: average estimated loss 0.20 pawns over 50 moves. This is not a career accuracy measure.

Three drills before the event

- Open Sicilian classical setup through move 12.
- QGD against Nf3 move orders.
- Forcing-move scan at moves 20-25: checks, captures, threats.

Pairing-day final check

Check	Write one answer
Expected pawn structure	_____
Opponent's main break	_____
My worst piece after development	_____
Clock floor at move 20	55 minutes

WIM Lindri Juni Widjayanti - color plan

SEED 8 INA FIDE 7100361	WIM Lindri Juni Widjayanti Rating 2127	LOW EVIDENCE Recent games: 3
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PRIORITY B - BOTTOM LINE
Low-confidence current report: only three recent classical games. The reliable broad tendency is 1.e4 as White; her Black opening choices require a flexible 1.e4 response sheet.

ARLAN HAS WHITE
Prepared line: 1.e4
Plan: Against 1...e5 use a quiet Italian; against 1...e6 use the Tarrasch French; against a Pirc use Nf3, Be2 and O-O before expanding.
Avoid: Avoid a mainline Ruy Lopez memory test. Her career Black results in that family are much stronger than in the French.

ARLAN HAS BLACK
Prepared line: 1.e4 c5 2.Nf3 d6 3.d4 cxd4 4.Nxd4
Plan: Play the rehearsed Najdorf. Her two 2024 White losses were Open Sicilians, including a Najdorf.
Avoid: Do not mix Najdorf and Sveshnikov ideas. Pick the known structure and complete development.

Games and results

Game sample	Games	W-D-L	Score
Career classical (1984-2024)	100	33-28-39	47.0%
Recent classical (2022+)	3	1-0-2	33.3%
Recent as White	2	0-0-2	0.0%
Recent as Black	1	1-0-0	100.0%
Recent games 41+ moves	3	1-0-2	33.3%

Opening tendencies

Question	Recent 2022+ (3 games)	Career reference
Opponent has White: first move	e4 2 (100%)	e4 44 (94%), d4 2 (4%), Nf3 1 (2%)
Opponent has Black vs 1.e4	d6 1 / 100.0%	e5 14 / 57.1%, e6 7 / 28.6%, d5 2 / 50.0%, d6 1 / 100.0%

Recorded opening sequences

Opponent has	Recorded opening sequence	Games / score
White	1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6	7 / 50.0%
White	1.e4 c5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.d4 cxd4	5 / 70.0%
Black vs 1.e4	1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bb5 a6 4.Ba4 Nf6	6 / 66.7%
Black vs 1.e4	1.e4 e5 2.Nc3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Nf6 4.d3 Na5	2 / 25.0%

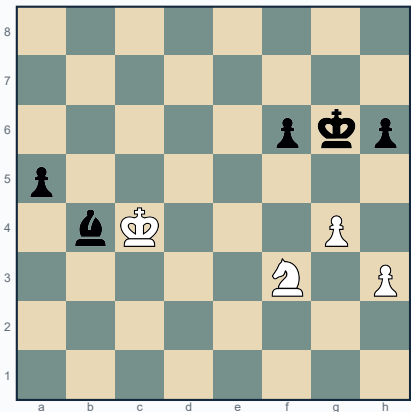
Practical notes

- Aim: King-safety decisions and late rook/endgame calculation, with a strong low-sample warning.
- Watch for: The career file reaches back to 1984. Old opening frequencies are context, not a prediction of the 2026 choice.

Percentages above are opponent scores, not Arlan scores. Small line samples are preparation prompts, not predictions.

WIM Lindri Juni Widjayanti - practice positions

Use these games to train decisions, not to memorize the opponent's mistakes. Recreate each critical position, set five minutes, and write three possible moves before checking the engine line. Positive engine values favor the opponent; negative values favor Arlan.



2024.09.20 | White vs Park,Sunwoo | Loss

Opening: Sicilian Defense: Lasker-Pelikan Variation, Sveshnikov Variation (B33)

Recorded line: 1.e4 c5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.d4 cxd4 4.Nxd4 Nf6 5.Nc3 e5

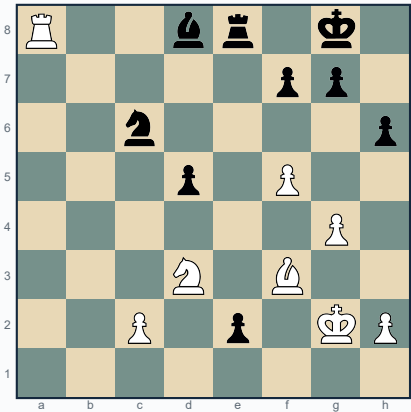
Critical moment: 49.Kd3 - played Kd3; Stockfish preferred Kb5

Engine check: serious error, 1.61 pawns; evaluation for the opponent -0.66 to -2.27

Best line: 1.Kb5 Kf7 2.Nd4 Bc3 3.Ne2

Study theme: The 2024 Sveshnikov loss includes O-O-O when O-O was safer, then a late king move. Make king safety an explicit decision.

Selected-game engine check: average estimated loss 0.28 pawns over 44 moves. This is not a career accuracy measure.



2024.09.15 | White vs Eman,Sawaw | Loss

Opening: Sicilian Defense: Najdorf Variation (B94)

Recorded line: 1.e4 c5 2.Nf3 d6 3.d4 cxd4 4.Nxd4 Nf6 5.Nc3 a6

Critical moment: 39.Bxd5 - played Bxd5; Stockfish preferred Ne1

Engine check: blunder, 4.20 pawns; evaluation for the opponent -0.56 to -4.76

Best line: 1.Ne1 Kf8 2.f6 Bxf6 3.Rxe8+

Study theme: The Najdorf loss turned through Nc5 and Rb6 before the final Bxd5 blunder. Preserve rook activity and verify captures.

Selected-game engine check: average estimated loss 0.34 pawns over 46 moves. This is not a career accuracy measure.

Three drills before the event

- One Najdorf main line and one anti-Sicilian backup.
- Castle-side comparison: write three reasons before choosing O-O-O.
- Single-rook ending: active king versus pawn-grabbing.

Pairing-day final check

Check	Write one answer
Expected pawn structure	_____
Opponent's main break	_____
My worst piece after development	_____
Clock floor at move 20	55 minutes

IM Angelo Young - color plan

SEED 9 PHI FIDE 5200490	IM Angelo Young Rating 2119	HIGH EVIDENCE Recent games: 60
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PRIORITY A - BOTTOM LINE

A likely opponent in the Swiss with clear opening-sequence habits: d4/Nf3 as White, mixed Sicilian/Pirc as Black. Use 1.e4 with White and a strict ...d5 structure with Black.

ARLAN HAS WHITE Prepared line: 1.e4 Plan: Against 1...c5 play 2.Nf3 and 3.d4; against 1...d6 use a quiet Classical setup with Nf3, Be2 and O-O. Avoid: Do not drift into a King's Indian as White. His recent Black results there are strong.	ARLAN HAS BLACK Prepared line: 1.d4 d5 2.Nf3 Nf6 3.g3 e6 Plan: Use a QGD/Slav setup and prepare ...c5. Prevent long Catalan pressure by contesting the center early. Avoid: Do not answer 1.Nf3 with a vague bishop-on-g2 setup. He is comfortable when both sides develop their bishops to g2 and g7.
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Games and results

Game sample	Games	W-D-L	Score
Career classical (2018-2025)	100	33-31-36	48.5%
Recent classical (2022+)	60	21-15-24	47.5%
Recent as White	29	10-8-11	48.3%
Recent as Black	31	11-7-13	46.8%
Recent games 41+ moves	30	11-4-15	43.3%

Opening tendencies

Question	Recent 2022+ (60 games)	Career reference
Opponent has White: first move	d4 21 (72%), Nf3 6 (21%), e4 1 (3%), Nc3 1 (3%)	d4 33 (69%), Nf3 12 (25%), e4 2 (4%), Nc3 1 (2%)
Opponent has Black vs 1.e4	c5 5 / 20.0%, d6 4 / 75.0%, g6 1 / 50.0%, e6 1 / 50.0%	c5 11 / 40.9%, d6 5 / 70.0%, e6 3 / 50.0%, g6 1 / 50.0%

Recorded opening sequences

Opponent has	Recorded opening sequence	Games / score
White	1.d4 Nf6 2.Nf3 g6 3.g3 Bg7	4 / 75.0%
White	1.d4 Nf6 2.Nf3 c6 3.Bg5 Qb6	1 / 100.0%
Black vs 1.e4	1.e4 d6 2.d4 Nf6 3.Nc3 c6 4.f4 Qa5	2 / 50.0%
Black vs 1.e4	1.e4 c5 2.Nf3 d6 3.d4 cxd4 4.Nxd4 Nf6	2 / 0.0%

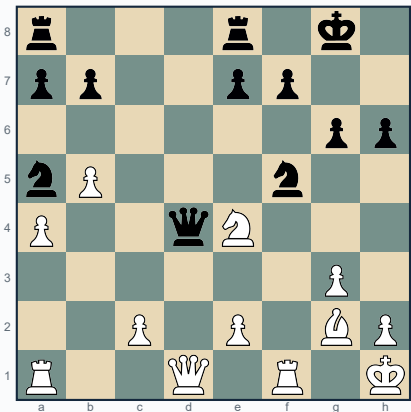
Practical notes

- Aim: Long technical pressure. Half of the recent games reached move 41, and most recent losses were late.
- Watch for: His Black opening choices are broad; the Pirc/Czech system has scored better than his Sicilian in the current file.

Percentages above are opponent scores, not Arlan scores. Small line samples are preparation prompts, not predictions.

IM Angelo Young - practice positions

Use these games to train decisions, not to memorize the opponent's mistakes. Recreate each critical position, set five minutes, and write three possible moves before checking the engine line. Positive engine values favor the opponent; negative values favor Arlan.



2025.12.20 | White vs Nguyen,Thanh Thuy Tien | Loss

Opening: Queen's Pawn Game: Symmetrical Variation, Pseudo-Catalan (D02)

Recorded line: 1.d4 d5 2.Nf3 Nf6 3.g3 c5 4.Bg2 cxd4 5.O-O h6

Critical moment: 21.Qe1 - played Qe1; Stockfish preferred Qxd4

Engine check: serious error, 1.56 pawns; evaluation for the opponent -0.22 to -1.78

Best line: 1.Qxd4 Nxd4 2.Nc5 Rab8 3.Rad1

Study theme: Qe1 missed the active Qxd4. The recurring theme is a passive queen retreat when central activity is available.

Selected-game engine check: average estimated loss 0.34 pawns over 29 moves. This is not a career accuracy measure.

SMALL ERRORS ADDED UP

Replay the full game and mark the first position where the plan became passive.

2025.12.20 | Black vs Wagh,Suyog | Loss

Opening: Slav Indian (A50)

Recorded line: 1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 c6 3.Nf3 g6 4.Bf4 d6 5.Nc3 Bg4

No single change of 0.60 pawns or more appeared after move 5 in the selected depth-12 engine check.

Study theme: The Black-side loss had no single 0.60-pawn error after move 5 in the depth-12 engine check. Study how several small decisions added up, not one large mistake.

Selected-game engine check: average estimated loss 0.11 pawns over 13 moves. This is not a career accuracy measure.

Three drills before the event

- Open Sicilian against 2...d6.
- QGD against Nf3-g3 move orders.
- Queen activity: compare a queen trade, a queen retreat and an active queen capture.

Pairing-day final check

Check	Write one answer
Expected pawn structure	_____
Opponent's main break	_____
My worst piece after development	_____
Clock floor at move 20	55 minutes

WIM Anjela Khegay - color plan

SEED 10 SGP FIDE 14200473	WIM Anjela Khegay Rating 2012	MEDIUM EVIDENCE Recent games: 13
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PRIORITY A - BOTTOM LINE

Her colors are predictable: 1.d4 as White and Modern/Pirc against 1.e4. Arlan should answer with the Slav and a controlled Be3 setup, not a race to opposite-side attacks.

ARLAN HAS WHITE

Prepared line: 1.e4 g6 2.d4 Bg7 3.Nc3 d6 4.Be3

Plan: Add Nf3 and Qd2, then choose castling based on the center. Use h3 before g4 when Black's queen and bishop are active.

Avoid: Do not castle long automatically. Her Modern positions reward active play against a king that has already committed to one side.

ARLAN HAS BLACK

Prepared line: 1.d4 d5 2.Nf3 Nf6 3.c4 c6 4.e3 Bf5

Plan: Use the Quiet Slav, complete ...e6 and ...Nbd7, and strike with ...c5. This also matches one of her recent White losses.

Avoid: Avoid the King's Indian and Benoni. Those are among her best career White families.

Games and results

Game sample	Games	W-D-L	Score
Career classical (1999-2026)	100	42-15-43	49.5%
Recent classical (2022+)	13	5-2-6	46.2%
Recent as White	6	3-1-2	58.3%
Recent as Black	7	2-1-4	35.7%
Recent games 41+ moves	7	5-1-1	78.6%

Opening tendencies

Question	Recent 2022+ (13 games)	Career reference
Opponent has White: first move	d4 6 (100%)	d4 46 (100%)
Opponent has Black vs 1.e4	g6 4 / 62.5%, d6 1 / 0.0%	g6 25 / 58.0%, c5 8 / 18.8%, d6 1 / 0.0%

Recorded opening sequences

Opponent has	Recorded opening sequence	Games / score
White	1.d4 Nf6 2.Nf3 e6 3.c4 Bb4	1 / 100.0%
White	1.d4 d5 2.c4 e6 3.Nc3 c5	1 / 100.0%
Black vs 1.e4	1.e4 g6 2.d4 Bg7 3.Nf3 d6 4.h3 Nf6	2 / 50.0%
Black vs 1.e4	1.e4 g6 2.d4 d6 3.Nc3 Bg7 4.Be3 a6	1 / 100.0%

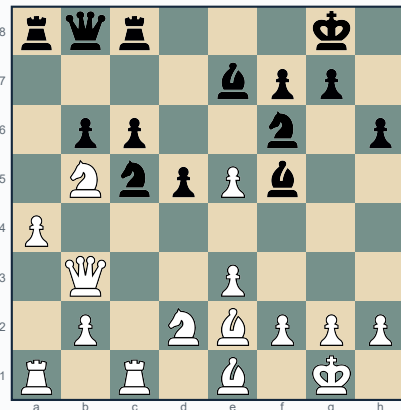
Practical notes

- Aim: Middlegame piece coordination. Five of six recent losses occurred before move 41; her late-game score is comparatively strong.
- Watch for: Do not simplify automatically. Her recent results are strongest in late games.

Percentages above are opponent scores, not Arlan scores. Small line samples are preparation prompts, not predictions.

WIM Anjela Khegay - practice positions

Use these games to train decisions, not to memorize the opponent's mistakes. Recreate each critical position, set five minutes, and write three possible moves before checking the engine line. Positive engine values favor the opponent; negative values favor Arlan.



2026.02.05 | White vs Susilodinata,Andreas | Loss

Opening: Slav Defense: Quiet Variation, Schallop Defense (D12)

Recorded line: 1.d4 d5 2.Nf3 Nf6 3.c4 c6 4.e3 Bf5 5.Nc3 e6

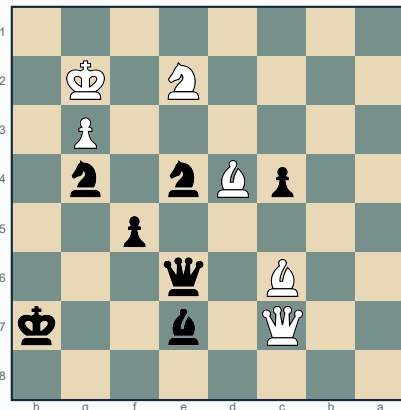
Critical moment: 18.Qd1 - played Qd1; Stockfish preferred Rxc5

Engine check: serious error, 1.72 pawns; evaluation for the opponent -0.10 to -1.82

Best line: 1.Rxc5 bxc5 2.exf6 c4 3.Nxc4

Study theme: Qd1 missed the active Rxc5. The theme is solving the center before retreating a major piece.

Selected-game engine check: average estimated loss 0.20 pawns over 23 moves. This is not a career accuracy measure.



2026.02.13 | Black vs Bonnet,Gabriel Misa Jean | Loss

Opening: Benoni Defense: Fianchetto Variation (A62)

Recorded line: 1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 c5 3.d5 e6 4.Nc3 exd5 5.cxd5 d6

Critical moment: 61...c3 - played c3; Stockfish preferred Ng5

Engine check: blunder, 3.47 pawns; evaluation for the opponent +0.12 to -3.35

Best line: 1.Ng5 Kf1 2.Nh2+ Kf2 3.Kh6

Study theme: As Black in the Benoni, three large swings came from move 30 onward. Keep checking checks, captures and threats when the position becomes tactical.

Selected-game engine check: average estimated loss 0.22 pawns over 57 moves. This is not a career accuracy measure.

Three drills before the event

- Modern Defense: Be3 setup with both castling options.
- Quiet Slav through the ...c5 break.
- Tactical center: compare Rxc5, retreat and pawn recapture.

Pairing-day final check

Check	Write one answer
Expected pawn structure	_____
Opponent's main break	_____
My worst piece after development	_____
Clock floor at move 20	55 minutes

Seven-day preparation sequence

RULE

Opening work ends with a position, not a move list. Every session must finish with: pawn structure, good and bad piece, opponent break, and the first move into an endgame.

Date	Primary work	Output
1 Aug	Lock White branches; Antonio Caro, Cao French	Two 10-move recall cards
2 Aug	Lock Black vs 1.e4; Moscow, Open Sicilian, quiet anti-Sicilian	Three key opening positions from memory
3 Aug	Lock Black vs d4/Nf3/c4; Slav-QGD move order	One structure, three move orders
4 Aug	Paciencia, Young, Kheday game plans	Six practice positions
5 Aug	Kiriakov, Tu, Than, Widjayanti cards	Backup line confirmed
6 Aug	One 90+30 simulation; start from a likely key opening position	Review of time use
7 Aug	Travel / technical meeting; light recall only	Sleep and logistics

Daily workload

- Opening recall: 35 minutes maximum per color.
- Practice positions: 4 positions x 8 minutes, then compare with the note.
- Endgame: 25 minutes, active-rook or Ruy Exchange structure.
- Physical reset: 30 minutes walking; no screen in the final hour before sleep.

During the tournament

- After each game, record only the opening surprise and one critical decision. Full analysis waits until the free day or after the event.
- On 10, 11 and 13 August, recovery takes priority between rounds. Use the opponent card; do not reopen the entire PGN file.
- If a lower seed appears, keep the same clock and structure discipline. The plan is to outplay, not to force.

WHAT THE COACH SHOULD SEND

When the pairing is posted, the coach should send only: color, prepared line, one recorded opening sequence, one diagram, and the avoid note. More information is not automatically better preparation.

Sources and method

Games included

Opponent	File	All	Classical	Recent
Petr Kiriakov	Kiriakov Petr	100	85	18
Tu Hoang Thong	Tu Hoang Thong	100	100	18
Cao Sang	Cao Sang	100	100	43
Rogelio Antonio Jr	Antonio Rogelio Jr	100	75	75
Enrique Paciencia	Paciencia Enrique Rivas	100	100	28
Than Min Hlaing	Than Min Hlaing	26	26	11
Lindri Juni Widjayanti	Lindri Juni Wijayanti	100	100	3
Angelo Young	Young Angelo	100	100	60
Anjela Kheday	Kheday Anjela	100	100	13

How this guide was built

- PGN game files were read by player name, duplicate games were removed, and openings were matched against a local reference containing 3,662 positions.
- Games marked in their event or site details as blitz, rapid, online, or similar were kept out of the standard-game sample.
- Recent means 2022-2026. When the recent sample was thin, the report shows career evidence as an older reference and clearly labels the limited confidence.
- Two recent classical losses per opponent were selected where possible. Stockfish checked only the opponent's moves in those games at depth 12. The reported critical positions are quick checks, not complete measures of playing accuracy.
- Recommendations were matched to Arlan's local game file and prior opening notes. They favor familiar 1.e4, Sicilian/Najdorf and Slav-QGD structures.

Event references

Starting list and tournament details: [Chess-Results event page](#)

Invitation schedule summary: [24th ASEAN+ event schedule](#)

Limitations

- The supplied files are not complete career databases. Missing games and errors in names or game details can change the percentages.
- Opening classification follows the deepest matched position. A position reached through a different move order may receive a different label from a commercial database.
- A current starting list can change. Recheck entries and pairings before each round.
- Engine depth 12 is adequate for a quick check, not for proving a new opening idea. Analyze any specific tactical line more deeply before using it.

FINAL COACHING RULE

This guide helps with decisions. Arlan should enter every round with one familiar structure, one opponent-specific reminder, and enough clock to play chess after preparation ends.